

Betalin Cream 0.05%w/w

Betamethasone Dipropionate

Product Description

A white cream pack in 5g tube.

Composition

Each gram of Betalin Cream contains 0.64mg of Betamethasone Dipropionate (0.5mg of Betamethasone).

Mode of Action

Betamethasone dipropionate is a corticosteroid and has anti-inflammatory, antipruritic and vasoconstrictive effects. It demonstrates these activities in a sustained manner, thereby permitting twice-a-day or, in some cases, once-a-day application.

Pharmacodynamics and pharmacokinetics

Pharmacodynamics

Betalin Cream preparations contain the dipropionate ester of betamethasone which is a glucocorticoid exhibiting the general properties of corticosteroids.

In pharmacological doses, corticosteroids are used primarily for their anti-inflammatory and/or immune suppressive effects.

Topical corticosteroids such as betamethasone dipropionate are effective in the treatment of a range of dermatoses because of their anti-inflammatory, anti-pruritic and vasoconstrictive actions. However, while the physiologic, pharmacologic and clinical effects of the corticosteroids are well known, the exact mechanisms of their action in each disease are uncertain.

Pharmacokinetics

Betamethasone dipropionate is readily absorbed from the gastrointestinal tract and also absorbed from sites of local administration. Sufficient betamethasone dipropionate may be absorbed to give systemic effects when used topically, particularly under an occlusive dressing or when the skin is broken, or as a rectal enema. Betamethasone dipropionate is rapidly distributed to all body tissues. It crosses the placenta and may be distributed in small amounts into breast milk. Like most corticosteroids, betamethasone in the circulation is extensively bound to plasma proteins, mainly to globulin and less so to albumin. Betamethasone dipropionate is metabolized mainly in the liver but also in other tissues and excreted in urine.

Indications

Betalin cream is indicated for the relief of the inflammatory manifestations of corticosteroid-responsive dermatoses such as: psoriasis, contact dermatitis (dermatitis venenata), atopic dermatitis (infantile eczema, allergic dermatitis), neurodermatitis (lichen simplex chronicus), lichen planus, eczema (including nummular eczema, hand eczema, eczematous dermatitis), intertrigo, dyshidrosis (pompholyx), seborrheic dermatitis, exfoliative dermatitis, solar dermatitis, stasis dermatitis and anogenital and senile pruritus.

Dosage and directions for use

Apply gently a thin strip of betamethasone dipropionate cream to the affected area once or twice daily or as prescribed by the physician.

Mode of Administration

Betalin Cream is administered by topically.

Contraindications

Betalin Cream is contraindicated for patient with a history of sensitivity reactions to any of the components of Betalin Cream.

It is also contraindicated on patient with rosacea, acne, perioral dermatitis, perianal and genital pruritus. Betalin Cream should not be used in napkin eruptions, fungal or bacterial skin infections without suitable concomitant anti-infective therapy.

Special warnings and precautions

Local and systemic toxicity is common, especially following long continuous use on large areas of damaged skin, in flexures or with polythene occlusion. If used in children or on the face courses should be limited to 5 days. Long term continuous therapy should be avoided in all patients irrespective of age.

If irritation or sensitization develops with the use of Betalin Cream, treatment should be discontinued.

In the presence of an infection, an appropriate antifungal or antibacterial agent should be administered. If a favorable response does not occur promptly, the corticosteroid should be discontinued until the infection has been controlled adequately.

Occlusion must not be used.

Topical corticosteroids may be hazardous in psoriasis for a number of reasons, including rebound relapses following development of tolerance, risk of generalised pustular psoriasis and local systemic toxicity due to impaired barrier function of the skin. Careful patient supervision is important.

Systemic absorption of topical corticosteroids will be increased if extensive body surface areas are treated or if the occlusive technique is used. Suitable precautions should be taken under these conditions or when long-term use is anticipated, particularly in infants and children.

Betalin Cream is not for ophthalmic use.

Interactions with Other Medicaments

There are no known drug interactions.

Statement on usage during pregnancy and lactation

There are no adequate and well controlled studies of the teratogenic potential of topically applied corticosteroids in pregnant women. Therefore topical steroids should be used during pregnancy only if the potential benefit justifies the potential risk to the foetus.

It is not known whether topical administration of corticosteroids would result in sufficient systemic absorption to produce detectable quantities in breast milk. Nevertheless, a decision should be made whether to discontinue the drug, taking into account the importance of the drug to the mother.

Adverse Effects/ Undesirable Effects

Side effects of Betalin Cream are Itching, irritation, dryness and burning at the area of application are the most commonly-noted side effects of betamethasone dipropionate. However, all of these are unusual.

Topical application of glucocorticoids may suppress the body's production of cortisol. If suppression has occurred for a long enough period of time, discontinuing the potent glucocorticoid can be associated with symptoms of glucocorticoid deficiency.

Glucose concentration in the blood can increase when there is an absorption of potent glucocorticoid and may cause symptoms of glucocorticoid excess manifested in weight gain, redistribution of fat stores and psychiatric problems. Suppression of inflammation and the immune response caused by glucocorticoid excess also allows infections to occur more easily.

Overdosage and Treatment

Symptoms: Excessive prolonged use of topical corticosteroids can suppress pituitary-adrenal function resulting in secondary adrenal insufficiency.

Treatment: Appropriate symptomatic treatment is indicated. Acute hypercorticotid symptoms are virtually reversible. Treat electrolyte imbalance, if necessary. In cases of chronic toxicity, slow withdrawal of steroids is advised.

Storage conditions

Store below 30°C. Keep out of reach of children.

Dosage Forms and packaging available

Betalin Cream is available in 5g boxed tube

Shelf-life

The cream can be used within 60 months from the date of manufacture if kept as recommended.

Registration number**BETALIN CREAM 0.5mg/g – MAL12035002AZ****Name and Address of Manufacturer**

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